CELPIP EXPRESS

Reading Test

STUDY MATERIALS - 18

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

PART 1

Read the following message.

Dear Mr. Casio,

I am writing in response to the letter I received this morning. First of all, I would like to tell you that I've enjoyed living in Minto Heights this past year and would like to stay another year. However, your letter says the new rent will be $1,500 a month. This is a big increase from the $1,100 I have been paying. Could we come to an agreement that both of us can accept?

My online research tells me that the rent increase is legal, but the price is unusual. A similar apartment (two bedrooms, 1,300 square feet, 5 years old, one underground parking spot) typically rents for $1,000 per month. This is less than what I'm paying now. In fact, most similar apartments include air conditioning, but mine doesn't.

I read in the newspaper that 4.1% of city apartments are empty this year and 4.4% will be vacant next year. This isn't surprising, as there are currently 200 new condominium buildings under construction in the city. Good tenants are valuable and hard to find. That's why I think you should charge the same rent next year. If you raise the rent, you might find someone willing to pay $400 more. However, it is equally possible that you will have an empty apartment earning zero income.

I feel that I am the type of tenant you would like to keep. I have always paid my rent on time. I haven't damaged the apartment. I don't smoke or play loud music, and I follow the "no pets" rule. I have always shovelled the snow off my balcony, as required in the lease. In addition, I have shovelled the front walkway, even though I'm not required to. This has helped to keep your other tenants safe.

If you agree to renew my lease at the current monthly rate, I will pay the first 3 months' rent in cash right away and the remainder in postdated cheques. Could you kindly let me know before May 1st if this is acceptable?

Sincerely,

Deborah Perrault

Choose the **best** option according to the information given in the message.

1. Why did Deborah write this letter?
- ◯ to defend herself against legal action
- ◯ to request a cheaper unit in her building
- ◯ to get permission to pay her rent late
- ◯ to ask her landlord to change his decision

2. What does Deborah currently pay for her apartment each month?
- ◯ one thousand dollars
- ◯ eleven hundred dollars
- ◯ four hundred dollars
- ◯ fifteen hundred dollars

3. What does Deborah suggest about her situation?
- ◯ Her landlord is unlikely to find another tenant like her.
- ◯ She would like to live permanently in Minto Heights.
- ◯ Her rental apartment requires a new air conditioner.
- ◯ She feels the neighbourhood is becoming too crowded.

4. What does Deborah say about the city's rental housing?
- ◯ There are some buildings offering rental discounts.
- ◯ There is a lack of available apartments.
- ◯ There will be many new apartment renters soon.
- ◯ There are many apartments that are available.

5. What does Deborah offer to do?
- ◯ pay part of her rent in cash immediately
- ◯ pay her rent in cash every three months
- ◯ pay three months' rent by cheque right now
- ◯ pay the full year's rent by postdated cheques

6. Deborah believes that _____
- ◯ she is a good person to rent to.
- ◯ tenants should be more considerate.
- ◯ she should move into a condominium.
- ◯ rental prices are high in the city.

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

PART 1

Here is a response to the message. Complete the response by filling in the blanks.

Dear Ms. Perrault,

Subject: 7._____

Thank you for your letter. It certainly isn't every day that an experienced 8._____ like me receives 9._____ such as you have written. I am impressed by your level of detail.

I agree with your suggestion in part; however, I will request that you provide 10._____ now and the balance in postdated cheques. This higher amount will help me feel more secure in the arrangement. If this is OK with you, then I will 11._____ everything else you mention in your letter and provide you with a new lease.

Please let me know as soon as possible. I look forward to your prompt reply.

Sincerely,

Antonio P. Casio

7.
- ◯ Payment for Maintenance and Repairs
- ◯ Termination of Lease - Unit 508
- ◯ Residential Tenancy Agreement No. 2093
- ◯ New Condo Development in Minto Heights

8.
- ◯ landlord
- ◯ superintendent
- ◯ condo developer
- ◯ real estate agent

9.
- ◯ an order
- ◯ a compliment
- ◯ a request
- ◯ an opinion

10.
- ◯ one rent cheque
- ◯ 4 months' rent
- ◯ 2 months' rent
- ◯ your overdue rent

11.
- ◯ repair
- ◯ return
- ◯ discuss
- ◯ approve

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

PART 2

Tips for Prospective Pet Owners

from Bedford's Best Pet Store

angie@bedfordbestpets.com

Did you know that 57% of Canadian households have pets, and that a few households even have more than one pet? Are you wondering what pet would bring the most joy to your family? Check out our guide below!

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Dogs

Dogs are favoured by 32% of Canadians, because they become part of the family, often joining in walks, drives, meals, gardening, and more. Many are attracted to dogs for their friendliness.

Dogs usually

- have large appetites
- require walks 3–5 times a day
- need lots of love and attention
- require frequent brushing and baths
- respond well to training programs
- need annual veterinary appointments

Cats

Cats can be found in 37% of Canadian homes. Cats are also part of the family, but they love to have some independence, as well. Spend time with your cat and she will return your affection.

Cats usually

- have small appetites
- enjoy indoor living but also love to be outdoors; don't let them run wild!
- love attention but are also happy to spend some time alone
- are unresponsive to training
- require biannual veterinary visits

Other Pets

Nine percent of Canadians have other pets, such as fish, birds, turtles, and small mammals, such as rabbits and ferrets. Owners must be very attentive to their special diets and purchase additional equipment such as cages. With some effort, small mammals can be trained and are usually very loving toward their owners.

Read the following email message about the diagram on the left. Complete the email by filling in the blanks

To: Angie Mills <angie@bedfordbestpets.com>
From: Bob Graves <bob.graves@emailcanada.ca>
Subject: Your Flyer Tips

Hello Angie,

I received your flyer in my mailbox and the timing was perfect. Now that our kids are old enough for pet maintenance, we'd like to add a furry four-legged member to our family.

Most pet owners seem to prefer having 1._____ . However, our kids, as usual, want to do things differently! With the category "other pets," I'm wondering 2._____ . It would be great to have more details about this group, like your points about cats and dogs, especially regarding their 3._____ .

I guess dogs are popular because, as you've mentioned, they 4._____ . My best friends say spending time playing and walking with them relieves stress from work too. However, as you suggest, even a rabbit or a ferret can be 5._____ , and I think either of those would be great for beginner pet-owners.

Do you have any additional information about those that you could share with us?

Thanks,

Bob

1. ◯ cats
   ◯ dogs
   ◯ multiple pets
   ◯ pets in cages

2. ◯ whether they need special food
   ◯ whether any can be trained
   ◯ why they are not as popular
   ◯ why there are no positive points

3. ◯ training ability
   ◯ medical needs
   ◯ food requirements
   ◯ overall popularity

4. ◯ share their affection
   ◯ can run in the wild
   ◯ can adapt to indoor living
   ◯ look very attractive

5. ◯ easily trained
   ◯ very hard
   ◯ easily fed
   ◯ very affectionate

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

PART 2

Choose the best option.

6. What does Bob mainly want advice about?

- ◯ adding a second pet to his family
- ◯ the most suitable dog breed for kids
- ◯ the benefits of fish and birds as pets
- ◯ caring for pet rabbits and ferrets

7. What does Bob suggest about his kids?

- ◯ They need to get more exercise.
- ◯ They prefer not to follow traditions.
- ◯ They are very young children.
- ◯ They are not very responsible.

8. What do Bob's friends say about dogs?

- ◯ They are the best pets.
- ◯ They require a lot of work.
- ◯ They benefit mental health.
- ◯ They help people stay fit.

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PART 3

Read the following passage.

A. 2015 was a big year for all of Canada. Toronto hosted both the Pan American and the Parapan American Games. The Games are one of the largest multi-sport events in the world, along with the Olympic Summer Games and the Asian Games. The Pan American Games (also known as the Pan Am Games) offer opportunities for thousands of top-notch athletes from North, Central, and South America and the Caribbean to compete in a variety of summer sports. The Parapan American Games welcome athletes with physical disabilities. The Games offer great pageantry, excitement, and sportsmanship to sports fans and residents alike.

B. The Pan Am Games started in 1951 in Buenos Aires, Argentina. The first Parapan Am Games were held in Mexico City in 1999. The Games have grown in size with each passing year: participation has increased from 2,500 athletes representing 14 nations at the first competition to over 6,000 contenders from 41 countries at the last games. Both the Pan Am and Parapan Am Games take place every four years, in the year before the Summer Olympics and Paralympic Games. Thirty-six sports (eight more than the official Olympic sports) are now featured at the Games. Pan Am sports not found at the Olympics include bowling, karate, baseball, and squash.

C. The celebration of the Pan American Games features such rituals and emblems as its own flag, torch, and anthem, in addition to opening and closing ceremonies. Each event also has a mascot—an animal or human figure representing the cultural heritage of the host country. This helps to create a distinct identity and promote the Games. The official mascot of the Toronto Games was Pachi the Porcupine, an animal native to Canada. His depiction was created by a group of eighth grade students from Markham, Ontario. Four friends put their heads together, spent two months perfecting their porcupine, and won the highly competitive Mascot Creation Challenge.

D. The 2015 Games were not the first for Canada; Winnipeg, Manitoba, has welcomed renowned athletes from the Americas twice in the past. The most recent Pan Am and Parapan Am Games brought in over 10,000 athletes, coaches, and delegates, along with as many as 250,000 visitors who came to cheer them on. This major international event created immense opportunities for all Canadians, helping to showcase Toronto and Ontario to an international audience, as well as attracting tourists, developing jobs, and encouraging new business investment. Beyond 2015, the Games will provide housing, transportation, educational, and recreational legacies for decades to come.

E. Not given in any of the above paragraphs.

Decide which paragraph, A to D, has the information given in each statement below.

Select E if the information is not given in any of the paragraphs.

1. The Games are as much a parade of athleticism as they are an opportunity to have fun.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

2. Athletes from the Americas must compete in the Pan Am Games in order to qualify for the Summer Olympics.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

3. The scope of the Pan American Games has been widening steadily.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

4. Large-scale international competitions augment the host country's infrastructure.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

5. The Pan Am Games feature more sports, so they are more important than the Olympics.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

6. The Parapan Am Games are a more recent addition to the international sports arena.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

7. The design competition for the Games was open to the public.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

8. Host countries select befitting symbols to publicize their culture throughout the Games.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

9. The Pan Am Games provide a fiscal boost to the host region.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

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PART 4

Read the following article from a website.

A Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) is a constructive means for an employer to provide an underperforming employee with the opportunity to regain good standing in the company. A PIP outlines measurable criteria for improved performance and sets deadlines for meeting said criteria. It also presents actions the employer will take to support the employee in reaching the PIP targets.

Nonetheless, not everyone views PIPs as well-intentioned. According to David Brown, HR manager at a leading recruiting agency, "PIPs might as well be called 'first step toward firing plans.' Employers use PIPs as a tool to initiate an employee's dismissal. In effect, companies shield themselves from liability by creating a paper trail of evidence that can be used against an employee in the case of termination. If you have been given a PIP, the company has made up its mind. It's time to polish your resumé and start job hunting."

Jane Doris, a seasoned corporate manager, disagrees, emphasizing that PIPs clearly demonstrate a company's commitment to an employee. "If your management has grounds for terminating your contract, they usually simply carry out that decision. If instead they invest their time in a PIP, they likely want to give you a chance." In some cases, the problem is caused by the individual's lack of training or by a lack of transparency regarding the employer's expectations. Doris goes on to say that this is where the solution lies. "By simply clarifying performance requirements, employees on PIPs are given time to prove themselves."

Those who are determined to succeed after a PIP may want to heed the advice of Demi Vazquez, CEO of KC Hiring Solutions: "At the outset, you should make sure your PIP goals are transparent and free of any ambiguity. Then, ask about resources like coaching or literature that could help you achieve your PIP goals. You might also consider asking your overachieving colleagues about their secrets for acing their daily responsibilities. Finally, track your progress daily and share it with your manager in regularly scheduled meetings."

Choose the **best** option according to the information given on the website.

1. What is the main topic of this article?

- ◯ a convenient tool to assess employees
- ◯ a productivity monitor for companies
- ◯ a collaborative way to train workers
- ◯ a controversial human resources tool

2. David Brown believes PIPs are _____

- ◯ unjustified.
- ◯ uninformative.
- ◯ ineffective.
- ◯ insincere.

3. What is probably true about Jane Doris?

- ◯ She doesn't use any PIPs at her company.
- ◯ She has little experience in managing staff.
- ◯ She only uses PIPs for promising staff.
- ◯ She doesn't believe in additional training.

4. What would Jane Doris probably agree with?

- ◯ PIPs can rectify gaps in an employee's understanding.
- ◯ Employees should write the objectives of their own PIPs.
- ◯ PIPs help employers to improve their business procedures.
- ◯ Employers should make quick decisions about employees.

5. What does Demi Vasquez seem to suggest?

- ◯ Employees need PIPs for their daily work.
- ◯ Employees should show initiative.
- ◯ Employers should set ambitious goals.
- ◯ Employers need outside resources.

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PART 4

The following is a comment by a visitor to the website page. Complete the comment by choosing the best option to fill in each blank.

Unlike David Brown, I firmly believe that employees should look at PIPs as a 6._____ . While a PIP might just seem like a pretext for dismissal, employees can also draw valuable 7._____ from them. I once naively believed what Jane Doris said about companies 8._____ by implementing PIPs. Having been on the receiving end, however, I have to side with Brown. As Brown suggests, after receiving a PIP, I was 9._____ . This ended up being the best thing for my career. So here's my advice: if you're ever given a PIP, forget about Vazquez's 10._____ . Your dream job could be just around the corner!

Jesse Donovan

6. ◯ way forward in their career
   ◯ path to their termination
   ◯ legal tool to benefit them
   ◯ company's final decision

7. ◯ information about their abilities
   ◯ details about new job opportunities
   ◯ protection from liability
   ◯ support from their peers

8. ◯ investing in their workers
   ◯ delaying difficult decisions
   ◯ establishing grounds for firing
   ◯ improving training programs

9. ◯ provided with training
   ◯ demoted at work
   ◯ let go from my job
   ◯ given a second chance

10. ◯ advice on actions you can take against it
    ◯ justifications for employers' policies
    ◯ resources for creating workplace transparency
    ◯ suggestions for improving performance

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

Answer Key

PART 1	
Question 1	to ask her landlord to change his decision
Question 2	eleven hundred dollars
Question 3	Her landlord is unlikely to find another tenant like her.
Question 4	There are many apartments that are available.
Question 5	pay part of her rent in cash immediately
Question 6	she is a good person to rent to.
Question 7	Residential Tenancy Agreement No. 2093
Question 8	landlord
Question 9	a request
Question 10	4 months' rent
Question 11	approve

PART 2	
Question 1	cats
Question 2	why they are not as popular
Question 3	medical needs
Question 4	share their affection
Question 5	very affectionate
Question 6	caring for pet rabbits and ferrets
Question 7	They prefer not to follow traditions.
Question 8	They benefit mental health.

PART 3	
Question 1	A
Question 2	E
Question 3	B
Question 4	D
Question 5	E
Question 6	B
Question 7	C
Question 8	C
Question 9	D

PART 4	
Question 1	a controversial human resources tool
Question 2	insincere.
Question 3	She only uses PIPs for promising staff.
Question 4	PIPs can rectify gaps in an employee's understanding.
Question 5	Employees should show initiative.
Question 6	way forward in their career
Question 7	information about their abilities
Question 8	investing in their workers
Question 9	let go from my job
Question 10	suggestions for improving performance

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -